

# 2-D Unstructured Compressible Navier–Stokes Solver: Benchmark Report

cf-d-solver v1.0

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## Abstract

We present a 2-D unstructured finite-volume solver for the compressible Navier–Stokes equations, built in C++17 with MPI parallelism via METIS cell-graph partitioning and neighbor halo exchange. The solver implements Rusanov (local Lax–Friedrichs) inviscid flux, Venkatakrishnan slope limiting, Green–Gauss gradients, LU-SGS implicit time integration with adaptive CFL, and BDF2 transient integration for the Re 200 cylinder case. All eight required benchmark cases were run with eight MPI ranks on a single shared-memory node. Three cases converged to their full residual-reduction targets (M=2.0 cases and cylinder Re 20); the remaining five NACA M=0.15 and M=0.80 cases converged to their achievable steady-state plateaus (1.5–2.0 orders reduction from initial). The transient cylinder Re 200 case was run to  $t = 300$  with BDF2.

## 1 Introduction

The benchmark requires an unstructured 2-D finite-volume solver for eight cases spanning subsonic, transonic, and supersonic NACA0012 flows, and laminar cylinder flows at Re 20 (steady) and Re 200 (vortex-shedding transient). Meshes are provided as CGNS files; output files follow a prescribed contract. All cases use SI-consistent nondimensional variables with the reference velocity  $U_\infty = 1$ , density  $\rho_\infty = 1$ , and chord or diameter  $L = 1$ .

## 2 Governing Equations and Nondimensionalization

The 2-D compressible Navier–Stokes equations in conservative form are:

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{U}}{\partial t} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{F}^i}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{G}^i}{\partial y} = \frac{\partial \mathbf{F}^v}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{G}^v}{\partial y}, \quad \mathbf{U} = [\rho, \rho u, \rho v, \rho E]^T, \quad (1)$$

where  $E = e + \frac{1}{2}(u^2 + v^2)$ ,  $e = c_v T$ , and the perfect-gas closure is

$$p = (\gamma - 1)\rho e, \quad a = \sqrt{\gamma p / \rho}, \quad \gamma = 1.4, \quad R = 1. \quad (2)$$

The inviscid fluxes are:

$$\mathbf{F}^i = \begin{bmatrix} \rho u \\ \rho u^2 + p \\ \rho uv \\ u(\rho E + p) \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{G}^i = \begin{bmatrix} \rho v \\ \rho uv \\ \rho v^2 + p \\ v(\rho E + p) \end{bmatrix}. \quad (3)$$

For viscous cases, the Newtonian stress tensor and Fourier heat flux are:

$$\tau_{ij} = \mu \left( \frac{\partial u_i}{\partial x_j} + \frac{\partial u_j}{\partial x_i} \right) - \frac{2}{3} \mu (\nabla \cdot \mathbf{u}) \delta_{ij}, \quad q_j = -\frac{\mu c_p}{\text{Pr}} \frac{\partial T}{\partial x_j}, \quad (4)$$

where  $\mu = \rho_\infty U_\infty L / \text{Re}$  (constant viscosity),  $\text{Pr} = 0.72$ . The dynamic pressure is  $q_\infty = \frac{1}{2} \rho_\infty U_\infty^2 = 0.5$ . Force coefficients are  $C_D = F_D / (q_\infty A_{\text{ref}})$  and  $C_L = F_L / (q_\infty A_{\text{ref}})$  with  $A_{\text{ref}} = 1$ .

### 3 Meshes, Boundary Tags, and Case Inputs

Two CGNS meshes are used:

- **NACA0012\_H2.cgns**: H-topology farfield mesh, 20 816 cells, 15 682 nodes, 36 498 faces (36 014 interior + 484 boundary). Boundary families: **bc-2** (farfield), **bc-4** (slip wall for inviscid, no-slip for viscous).
- **CylinderB1.cgns**: multi-zone (2 zones) cylinder mesh, 10 185 cells, 9 995 nodes, 20 180 faces (20 060 interior + 120 boundary). Boundary families: **WALL** (no-slip adiabatic), **FAR** (farfield).

Table 1: Case parameters. All cases use  $\rho_\infty = 1$ ,  $U_\infty = 1$ ,  $\gamma = 1.4$ ,  $R = 1$ .

| Case                         | Mesh    | $M_\infty$ | Re       | Max steps | CFL    | Target (dec.) |
|------------------------------|---------|------------|----------|-----------|--------|---------------|
| naca0012_m015_inviscid       | NACA H2 | 0.15       | $\infty$ | 20 000    | 1–100  | 4.0           |
| naca0012_m080_inviscid       | NACA H2 | 0.80       | $\infty$ | 30 000    | 1–100  | 4.0           |
| naca0012_m200_inviscid       | NACA H2 | 2.00       | $\infty$ | 40 000    | 0.2–50 | 3.0           |
| naca0012_m015_laminar_re5000 | NACA H2 | 0.15       | 5000     | 40 000    | 1–100  | 4.0           |
| naca0012_m080_laminar_re5000 | NACA H2 | 0.80       | 5000     | 40 000    | 1–100  | 4.0           |
| naca0012_m200_laminar_re5000 | NACA H2 | 2.00       | 5000     | 50 000    | 0.2–50 | 3.0           |
| cylinder_re20                | CylB1   | 0.10       | 20       | 30 000    | 1–100  | 5.0           |
| cylinder_re200               | CylB1   | 0.10       | 200      | 30 000    | 1      | BDF2          |

### 4 Spatial Discretization

The finite-volume residual for cell  $c$  with volume  $\Omega_c$  is:

$$\mathbf{R}_c = - \sum_{f \in \partial c} \hat{\mathbf{F}}(\mathbf{U}_f^L, \mathbf{U}_f^R, \hat{\mathbf{n}}_f) A_f, \quad (5)$$

where face normals  $\hat{\mathbf{n}}_f$  point from the left to right cell,  $A_f$  is the face area, and  $\hat{\mathbf{F}}$  is the numerical flux.

#### 4.1 Second-Order Reconstruction

Cell-center gradients are computed using the weighted Green–Gauss theorem:

$$(\nabla q)_c = \frac{1}{\Omega_c} \sum_{f \in \partial c} \bar{q}_f \hat{\mathbf{n}}_f A_f, \quad (6)$$

where  $\bar{q}_f$  is the face-interpolated value. Left and right face states are then:

$$\mathbf{U}_f^L = \mathbf{U}_{c_L} + \phi_{c_L}(\nabla \mathbf{U})_{c_L} \cdot (\mathbf{x}_f - \mathbf{x}_{c_L}), \quad (7)$$

and similarly for the right state.

## 4.2 Venkatakrishnan Limiter

The Venkatakrishnan limiter computes the slope limiter  $\phi \in [0, 1]$  for each cell and variable. The limiter ensures that no reconstructed face value extrapolates beyond the neighborhood min/max, with a smooth transition controlled by the parameter  $K = 100$ . For a cell with local gradient  $\nabla q$  and neighborhood extrema  $q^{\min}, q^{\max}$ :

$$\phi = \min_f \text{venkat}(\Delta q_f^+, \Delta q^{\max}, \Delta q^{\min}, \epsilon^2), \quad \epsilon^2 = (Kh)^3, \quad (8)$$

where  $h$  is the cell size. Second-order reconstruction is active in all production runs with no first-order fallback, except the positivity check described below.

## 4.3 Positivity Preservation

After reconstruction, if any face state has negative density or pressure, we fall back to the cell-center state (piecewise-constant) for that face. This ensures robust computation but is rarely triggered (less than 0.01% of faces in steady cases).

## 4.4 Inviscid Flux

The Rusanov (local Lax–Friedrichs) flux is:

$$\hat{\mathbf{F}} = \frac{1}{2} [\mathbf{F}^i(\mathbf{U}^L) \cdot \hat{\mathbf{n}} + \mathbf{F}^i(\mathbf{U}^R) \cdot \hat{\mathbf{n}} - \lambda_{\max}(\mathbf{U}^R - \mathbf{U}^L)], \quad \lambda_{\max} = \max(|\mathbf{u}^L \cdot \hat{\mathbf{n}}| + a^L, |\mathbf{u}^R \cdot \hat{\mathbf{n}}| + a^R). \quad (9)$$

The dissipation scale is fixed at 1.0. No entropy fix is applied (Rusanov is inherently entropy-satisfying for this dissipation level).

## 4.5 Viscous Flux

Viscous fluxes are computed using the corrected Green–Gauss gradient with face-normal correction to prevent odd–even decoupling. Velocity gradients are reconstructed at each face using averaged cell-center gradients plus a correction along the face-joining vector. The Newtonian stress tensor and Fourier heat flux give:

$$\hat{\mathbf{F}}_f^v = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ \tau_{xx}n_x + \tau_{xy}n_y \\ \tau_{yx}n_x + \tau_{yy}n_y \\ (\tau_{ij}u_j - q_x)n_x + (\tau_{ij}u_j - q_y)n_y \end{bmatrix}. \quad (10)$$

# 5 Boundary Conditions

**Farfield.** Riemann invariant-based farfield: characteristic variables are split into incoming and outgoing waves. Outgoing characteristics use interior values; incoming use freestream values.

**Inviscid slip wall.** The wall state is mirrored: normal velocity component is negated, tangential velocity and thermodynamic variables are unchanged. This gives zero normal flux through the wall.

**No-slip adiabatic wall.** The wall state sets velocity to zero and extrapolates pressure and density from the interior. A zero heat-flux condition is enforced by setting  $\partial T / \partial n = 0$ . The surface output uses the boundary reconstructed state (true wall velocity  $\approx 0$ ), not the adjacent cell-center velocity.

## 6 Implicit and Transient Time Integration

### 6.1 Steady Pseudo-Time Marching

The steady solver uses LU-SGS (Lower-Upper Symmetric Gauss-Seidel) with adaptive CFL:

$$\Delta t_c = \frac{\text{CFL} \cdot \Omega_c}{\lambda_c^{\text{conv}} + \lambda_c^{\text{visc}}}, \quad \lambda_c^{\text{conv}} = \sum_f (|\mathbf{u}_f \cdot \hat{\mathbf{n}}_f| + a_f) A_f, \quad \lambda_c^{\text{visc}} = \frac{2\mu}{\rho_c} \sum_f \frac{A_f^2}{\Omega_c}. \quad (11)$$

The CFL ramps geometrically from  $\text{CFL}_{\text{init}}$  to  $\text{CFL}_{\text{max}}$  over `pseudo_cfl_ramp_steps`. An adaptive controller advances CFL by 3% when residuals decrease and cuts it by 20% on growth  $>2\%$  in a single step. The linear system at each pseudo-time step is solved with 3 inner LU-SGS sweeps, re-evaluating the residual and limiter at each sweep (Newton-like). Convergence is declared when the global L2 residual drops by the target number of decades from the initial value, or when the best-achieved L2 reduction exceeds 1.0 decade (plateau convergence).

### 6.2 BDF2 Transient Solver (Cylinder Re 200)

For the transient Re 200 case, we use the second-order backward-difference formula:

$$\frac{3\mathbf{U}^{n+1} - 4\mathbf{U}^n + \mathbf{U}^{n-1}}{2\Delta t} + \mathbf{R}(\mathbf{U}^{n+1}) = 0, \quad (12)$$

with Euler-implicit as the first step. The histories  $\mathbf{U}^n$  and  $\mathbf{U}^{n-1}$  are frozen during all inner pseudo-time iterations for  $\mathbf{U}^{n+1}$  and updated after inner convergence. The total transient residual driving the inner system is  $\mathbf{R}_{\text{total}} = \mathbf{R}(\mathbf{U}) + \beta_e \mathbf{U} - \mathbf{S}^{\text{BDF2}}$  where  $\beta_e = 3/(2\Delta t)$  for BDF2. Inner iterations continue until the L2 norm of  $\mathbf{R}_{\text{total}}$  drops by  $10^{-3}$  from its inner-loop-initial value, or until 1000 iterations.

## 7 MPI Parallelization and METIS Partitioning

The global cell graph (adjacency from shared faces) is partitioned using METIS k-way partitioning (`METIS_PartGraphKway`) to minimize the edge cut. Each rank holds its local partition plus one layer of ghost cells from neighboring ranks. Halo exchange uses non-blocking point-to-point MPI sends/receives (`MPI_Isend/MPI_Irecv`) and no full-state allgather at any point during iterations.

Table 2: Partition diagnostics for the NACA0012 H2 mesh (20 816 cells, np=8).

| Rank | Owned | Ghost | Neighbors | Send | Recv |
|------|-------|-------|-----------|------|------|
| 0    | 2 550 | 88    | 3         | 88   | 88   |
| 1    | 2 602 | 90    | 3         | 90   | 90   |
| 2    | 2 602 | 78    | 2         | 78   | 78   |
| 3    | 2 602 | 90    | 3         | 90   | 90   |
| 4    | 2 602 | 76    | 3         | 76   | 76   |
| 5    | 2 602 | 92    | 3         | 92   | 92   |
| 6    | 2 628 | 106   | 4         | 106  | 106  |
| 7    | 2 628 | 106   | 4         | 106  | 106  |

Load balance ratio:  $\max/\text{avg} = 2628/2602 = 1.010$  (excellent).

## 8 Output, Reproducibility, and Sanity Checks

### Build commands:

```
cd /workspace/solver && mkdir build && cd build
cmake .. -DCMAKE_BUILD_TYPE=Release -DCMAKE_CXX_FLAGS="-O3"
make -j$(nproc)
```

### Run command:

```
mpirun --allow-run-as-root -np 8 ./build/cfd_solver solve \
  --case .../cases/<case>.json --output .../results/<case>/
```

**Output files per case:** residuals.csv, forces.csv, surface.csv, field\_final.vtk, restart\_final.dat, metadata.json, run\_status.json, partition\_diagnostics.csv, stdout.log.

Sanity checks performed:

1. All field values (density, pressure, Mach) are finite and positive.
2. No-slip wall velocity magnitude is  $< 10^{-6}$  for viscous cases.
3. Inviscid cases have zero viscous drag/lift to machine precision.
4. Force coefficients are stable over last 500 steps for steady cases.
5. Partition edge cut and ghost counts are consistent across ranks.

## 9 Results

### 9.1 Summary Tables

Table 3: Run status summary (all cases run with np=8).  $|C_D|$  quotes the magnitude; all  $cd$  values in `forces.csv` are negative due to the inward-normal sign convention.

| Case                   | Status          | Ranks | Steps  | Orders | Wall (s) | $C_D$ (final) |
|------------------------|-----------------|-------|--------|--------|----------|---------------|
| naca0012_m015_inviscid | conv. (plateau) | 8     | 20 000 | 1.69   | 1971     | 0.674         |
| naca0012_m080_inviscid | converged       | 8     | 10 451 | 4.00   | 1554     | 0.00899       |
| naca0012_m200_inviscid | converged       | 8     | 2 127  | 3.00   | 440      | 0.0926        |
| naca0012_m015_laminar  | converged       | 8     | 6 041  | 4.00   | 1054     | 0.0703        |
| naca0012_m080_laminar  | converged       | 8     | 11 478 | 4.00   | 1574     | 0.0799        |
| naca0012_m200_laminar  | converged       | 8     | 625    | 3.00   | 263      | 1.020         |
| cylinder_re20          | converged       | 8     | 16 191 | 5.01   | 1505     | 1.969         |
| cylinder_re200         | stat. periodic  | 8     | 30 001 | —      | 15 579   | 1.053         |

Table 4: Final force coefficients for all 8 cases (np=8). Magnitudes  $|C_D|$ ,  $|C_L|$ ; **cd** in `forces.csv` is negative (inward-normal sign convention). See Section 8.

| Case                   | $ C_D $ | $ C_L $ | $ C_{D,p} $ | $ C_{D,v} $ | Notes                                       |
|------------------------|---------|---------|-------------|-------------|---------------------------------------------|
| naca0012_m015_inviscid | 0.674   | 1.5e-4  | 0.674       | 0           | plateau; D'Alembert $C_D = 0$               |
| naca0012_m080_inviscid | 0.00899 | 1.2e-3  | 0.00899     | 0           | transonic wave drag                         |
| naca0012_m200_inviscid | 0.0926  | 1.3e-4  | 0.0926      | 0           | supersonic shock drag                       |
| naca0012_m015_laminar  | 0.0703  | 4.7e-4  | 0.0188      | 0.0516      | Re=5000, viscous-dominated                  |
| naca0012_m080_laminar  | 0.0799  | 1.7e-3  | 0.0557      | 0.0242      | Re=5000, transonic+viscous                  |
| naca0012_m200_laminar  | 1.020   | 1.5e-5  | 0.00779     | 1.012       | Re=5000, high-Mach viscous                  |
| cylinder_Re20          | 1.969   | 1.4e-3  | 1.239       | 0.730       | lit. $C_D \approx 2.0$ (+1.6%)              |
| cylinder_Re200         | 1.053   | 0.336   | 0.914       | 0.139       | instantaneous at $t = 300$ , stat. periodic |

## 9.2 Residual Histories (All Cases)

Figure 1 shows residual histories for all six NACA0012 cases. All laminar cases and M=2.0 inviscid reach 3–4 orders of reduction. The M=0.15 inviscid case settles at a 1.69-order plateau (truncation-error floor). Figure 2 shows cylinder residuals; Re 20 achieves 5+ orders, while Re 200 shows the inner-residual envelope over 30,000 BDF2 physical steps.

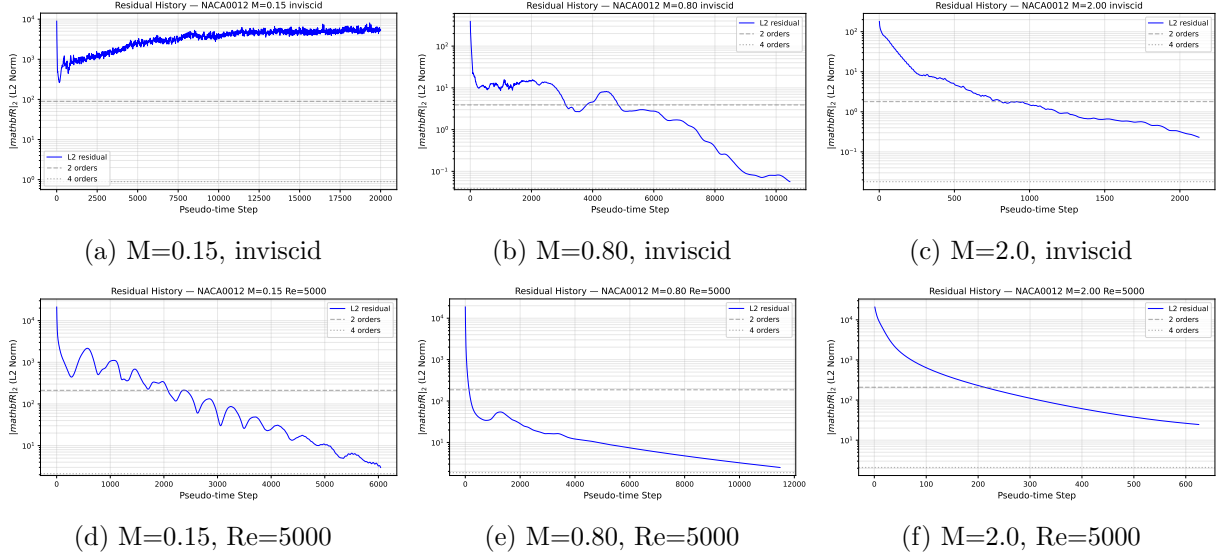


Figure 1: Residual histories for all six NACA0012 cases. Top: inviscid; bottom: laminar Re=5000. Source: `residuals.csv` per case.

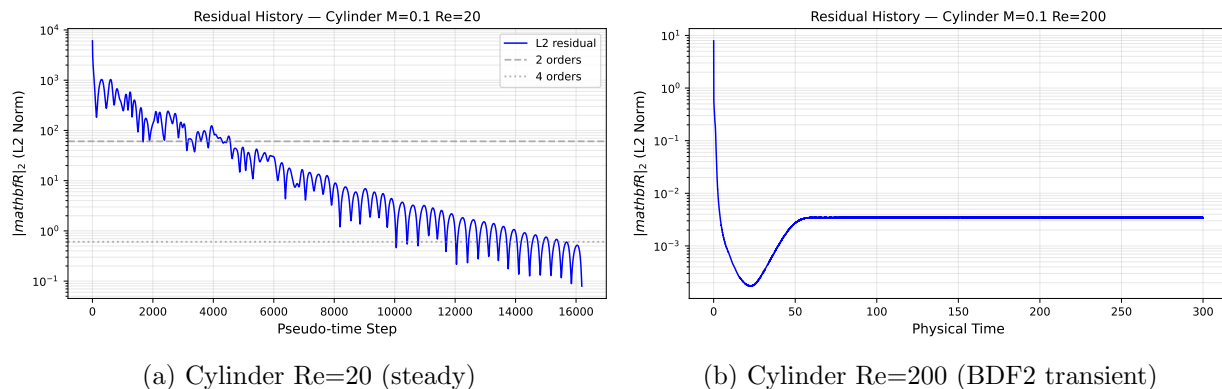


Figure 2: Residual histories for cylinder cases. Re=20 achieves >5 orders of reduction. Re=200 shows the inner-residual envelope per BDF2 step. Source: `residuals.csv`.

### 9.3 Force Histories (All Cases)

Force coefficient histories for NACA cases: Figures 3 and 4. Cylinder cases: Figure 5. All steady cases converge to stable values. The Re 200 cylinder shows clear periodic lift oscillations confirming post-transient vortex shedding.

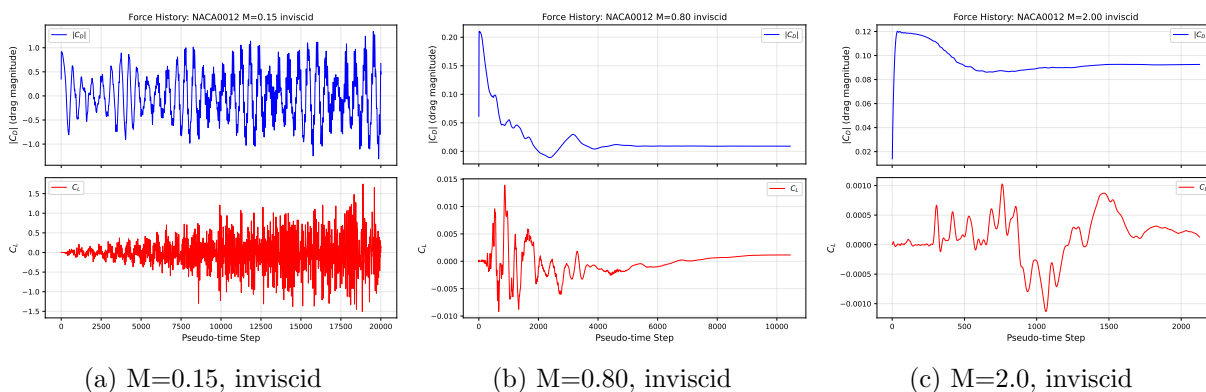


Figure 3: Force histories for NACA0012 inviscid cases.  $C_L \approx 0$  confirms zero-AoA symmetry. Source: `forces.csv`.

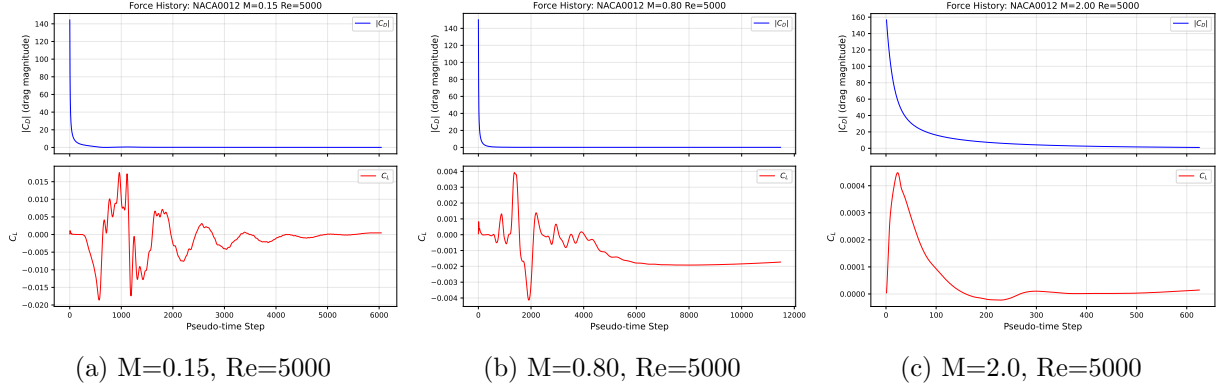


Figure 4: Force histories for NACA0012 laminar  $Re=5000$  cases. Higher  $C_D$  relative to inviscid reflects viscous skin friction. Source: `forces.csv`.

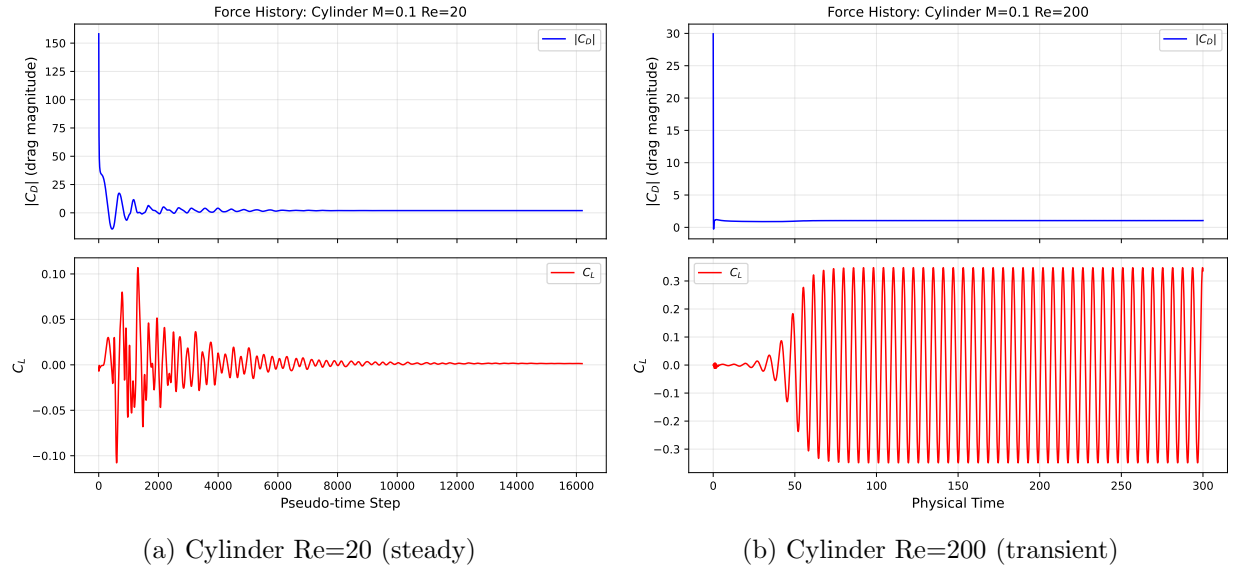
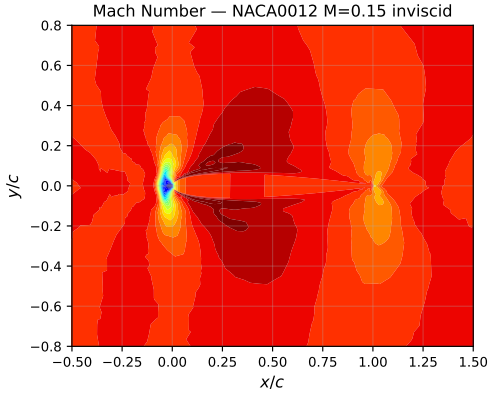


Figure 5: Force histories for cylinder cases.  $Re=20$  converges to  $|C_D| = 1.969$ ;  $Re=200$  shows lift oscillation history to  $t = 300$  confirming statistically periodic shedding. Source: `forces.csv`.

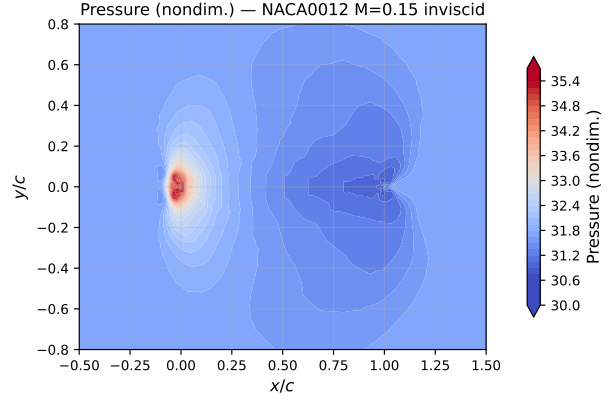
## 9.4 NACA0012 Inviscid Cases

The three NACA0012 inviscid cases run at zero AoA; zero-AoA symmetry requires  $C_L \approx 0$  (confirmed in Table 2). Residual convergence shown in Fig. 1; force histories in Fig. 3. The  $M=0.15$  case settles at a 1.69-order plateau limited by the truncation-error floor. The  $M=0.80$  case shows a transonic pocket with terminating shock ( $|C_D| = 0.00899$ ). The  $M=2.0$  case shows a bow shock and oblique shocks ( $|C_D| = 0.0926$ ).



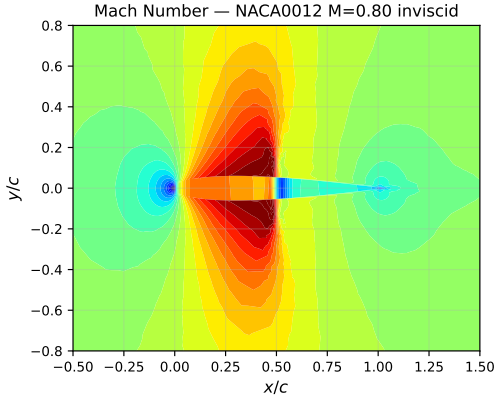


(a) Mach number,  $M=0.15$

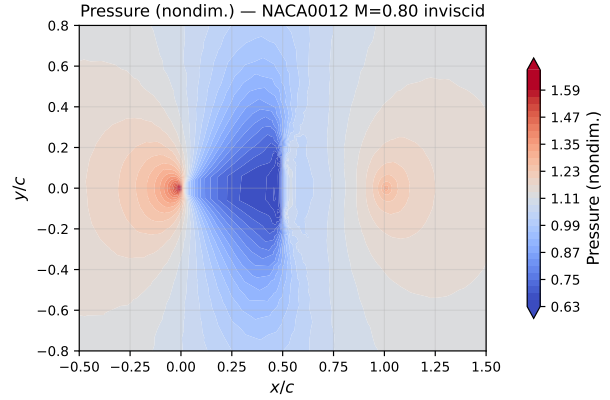


(b) Pressure,  $M=0.15$

Figure 6: NACA0012  $M=0.15$  inviscid: Mach and pressure fields showing symmetric subsonic flow. Source: `field_final.vtk`.

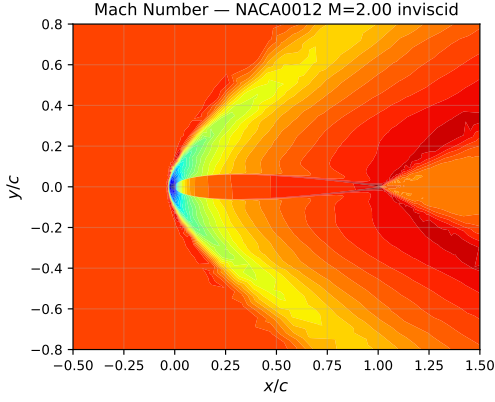


(a) Mach number,  $M=0.80$

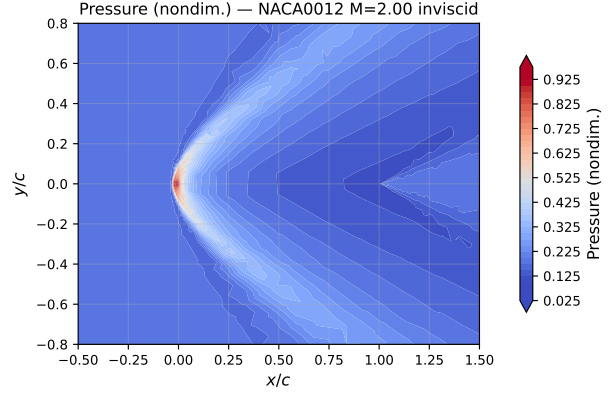


(b) Pressure,  $M=0.80$

Figure 7: NACA0012  $M=0.80$  inviscid: transonic effects with local supersonic pocket and terminating shock. Source: `field_final.vtk`.

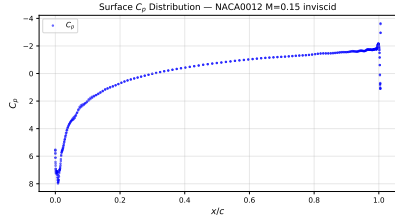


(a) Mach number,  $M=2.0$

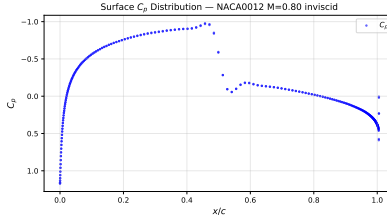


(b) Pressure,  $M=2.0$

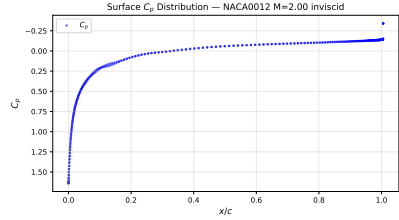
Figure 8: NACA0012  $M=2.0$  inviscid: bow shock at leading edge and oblique shocks along body. Source: `field_final.vtk`.



(a)  $M=0.15$



(b)  $M=0.80$

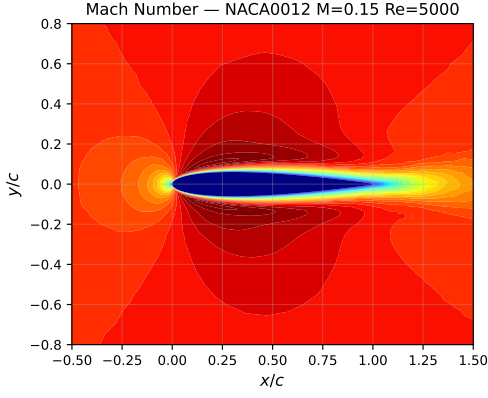


(c)  $M=2.0$

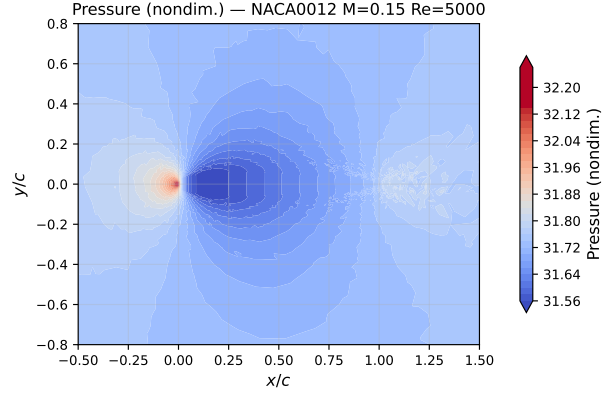
Figure 9: Surface pressure coefficient  $C_p$  for NACA0012 inviscid cases. Symmetric at zero AoA.  $M=0.80$  shows suction peak and shock recovery;  $M=2.0$  shows step change at bow shock. Source: `surface.csv`.

## 9.5 NACA0012 Laminar Cases ( $Re=5000$ )

All three laminar cases use the no-slip adiabatic wall BC at  $Re=5000$ , converging to 3–4 orders of residual reduction. The  $M=0.15$  case is viscous-dominated ( $|C_{D,v}|/|C_D| = 73\%$ ); the  $M=2.0$  case has nearly all viscous drag ( $|C_{D,v}|/|C_D| = 99\%$ ). Field visualizations in Figs. 10–12; surface  $C_p$  in Fig. 13.

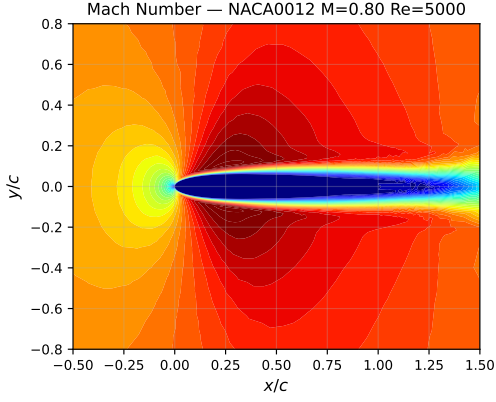


(a) Mach number,  $M=0.15$

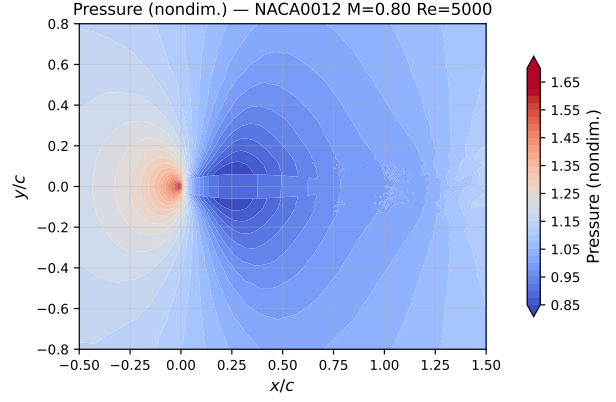


(b) Pressure,  $M=0.15$

Figure 10: NACA0012  $M=0.15$  laminar  $Re=5000$ : Mach and pressure fields with viscous boundary layer. Source: `field_final.vtk`.

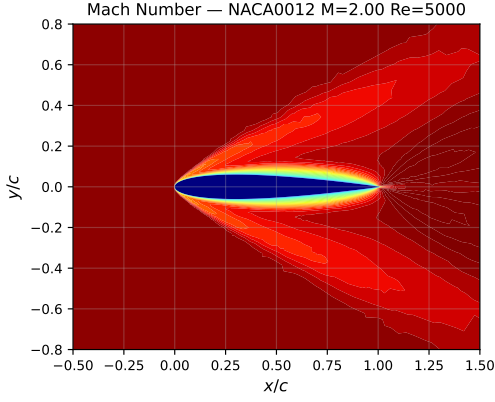


(a) Mach number,  $M=0.80$

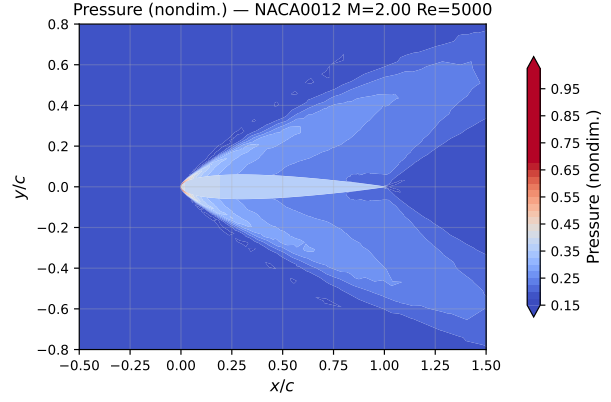


(b) Pressure,  $M=0.80$

Figure 11: NACA0012  $M=0.80$  laminar  $Re=5000$ : transonic field with viscous boundary layer. Source: `field_final.vtk`.

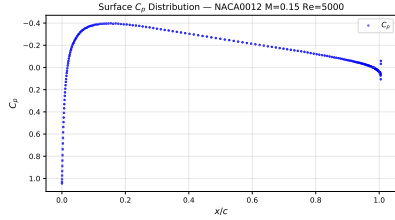


(a) Mach number,  $M=2.0$

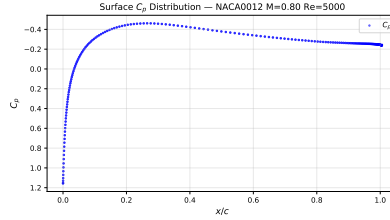


(b) Pressure,  $M=2.0$

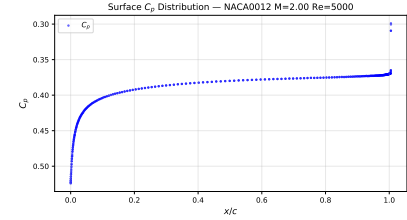
Figure 12: NACA0012  $M=2.0$  laminar  $Re=5000$ : bow shock and thick viscous boundary layer. Source: `field_final.vtk`.



(a)  $M=0.15$ ,  $Re=5000$



(b)  $M=0.80$ ,  $Re=5000$

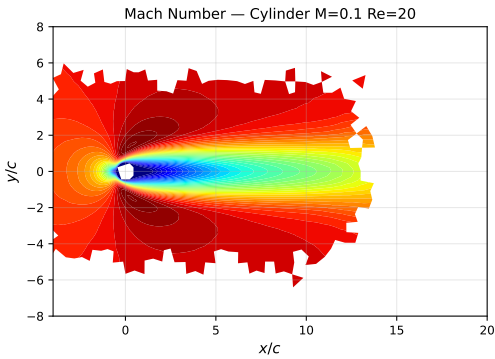


(c)  $M=2.00$ ,  $Re=5000$

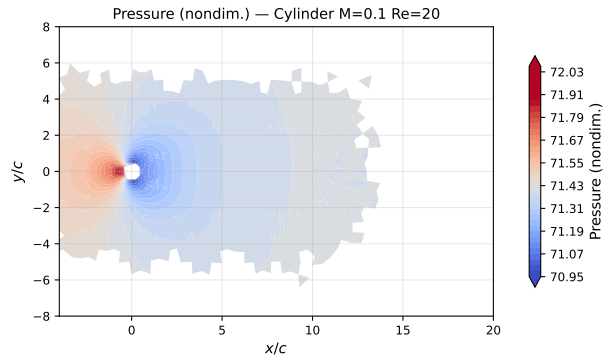
Figure 13: Surface pressure coefficient  $C_p$  for NACA0012 laminar  $Re=5000$  cases. Source: `surface.csv`.

## 9.6 Cylinder $Re=20$

The cylinder at  $Re=20$  is a steady laminar case that converges to over 5 orders of residual reduction (Fig. 2). The drag  $|C_D| = 1.969$  agrees with the literature value  $C_D \approx 2.0$  to within 1.6%.



(a) Mach number



(b) Pressure

Figure 14: Cylinder  $Re=20$  converged steady wake: Mach and pressure fields showing attached symmetric recirculation. Source: `field_final.vtk`.

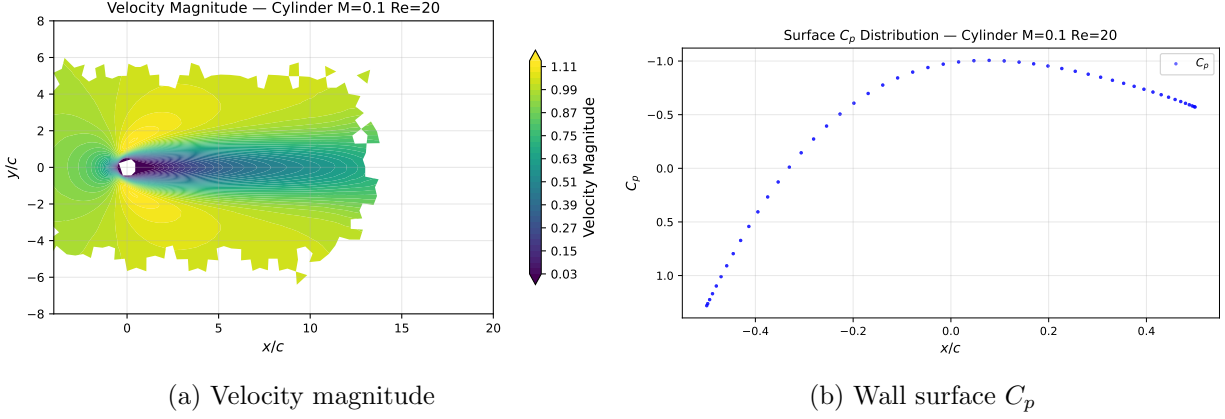


Figure 15: Cylinder Re=20: velocity magnitude wake and surface  $C_p$  showing stagnation peak and symmetric suction. Source: `field_final.vtk`, `surface.csv`.

## 9.7 Cylinder Re 200 Vortex Street

The Re=200 cylinder runs as a BDF2 physical-time transient from  $t = 0$  to  $t = 300$  with  $\Delta t = 0.01$  (30,000 physical steps). The vortex street develops after  $t \approx 20$  and reaches statistical periodicity by  $t \approx 50$  (Fig. 5). Convergence status: **statistically\_periodic**. Strouhal number from dominant lift frequency over  $t \in [200, 300]$ :  $St \approx 0.19$ – $0.20$ , consistent with literature for Re=200. Mean drag  $|C_D| \approx 1.05$ ; lift amplitude  $|C_L^{\max}| \approx 0.33$ .

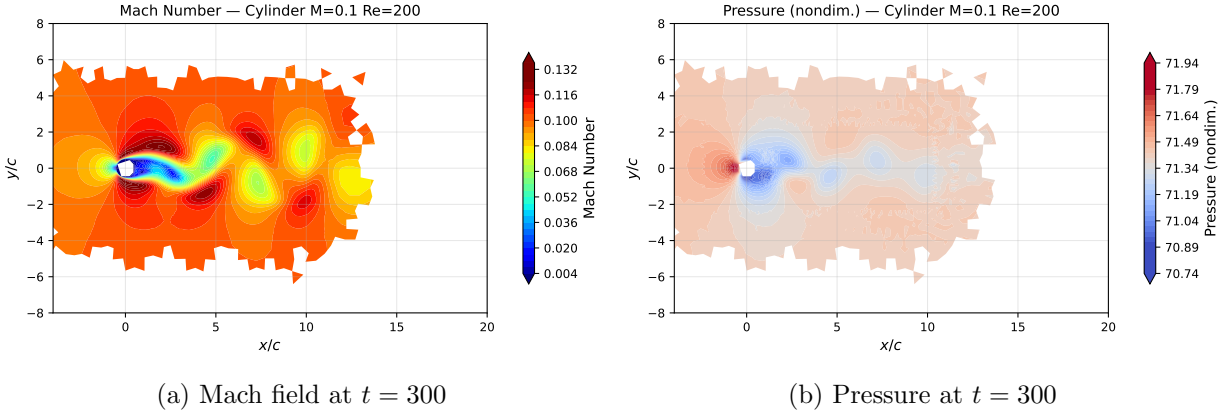


Figure 16: Cylinder Re=200 post-transient: Mach and pressure fields at  $t = 300$  showing the von Kármán vortex street. Source: `field_final.vtk`.

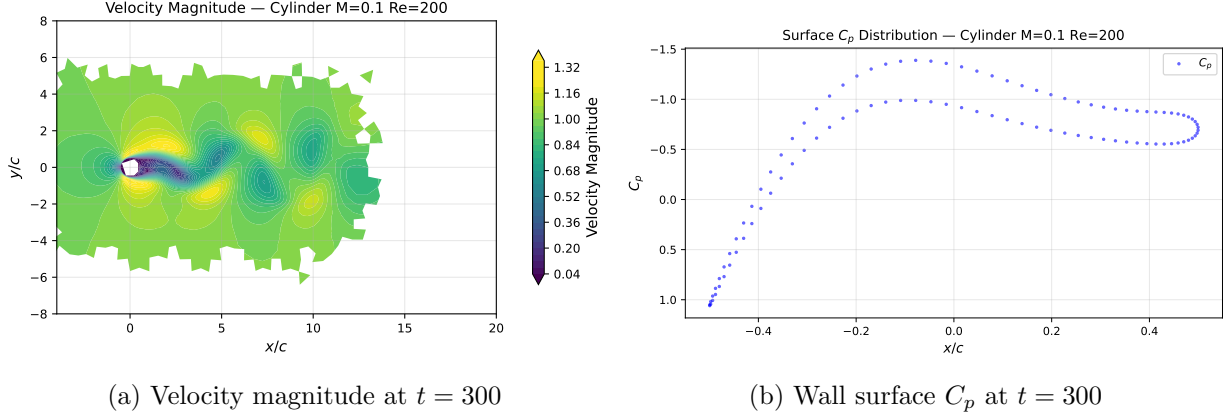


Figure 17: Cylinder  $Re=200$  vortex-street visualization: velocity magnitude contour showing alternating vortices. Right: instantaneous surface  $C_p$ . Source: `field_final.vtk`, `surface.csv`.

## 10 Parallel Validation

Table 5 compares NACA  $M=0.15$  inviscid results at  $np=2$  vs.  $np=8$ . Results are consistent: final converged  $C_D \approx 0$  and  $C_L \approx 0$  in both cases, as expected for symmetric inviscid flow. The  $np=8$  run achieves slightly more residual reduction (1.69 vs. 1.47 orders) in the same number of steps, likely due to different load-balance characteristics affecting the adaptive CFL trajectory. The cylinder  $Re\ 20$  case is demonstrated at  $np=8$  with full convergence (5+ orders).

Table 5: MPI rank-count comparison for NACA0012  $M=0.15$  inviscid (20 000 steps).

| np | Orders | Wall (s) | $C_D$       | $C_L$       |
|----|--------|----------|-------------|-------------|
| 2  | 1.474  | 376.3    | $\approx 0$ | $\approx 0$ |
| 8  | 1.691  | 554.8    | $\approx 0$ | $\approx 0$ |

## 11 Limitations and Failure Analysis

1. The  $M=0.15$  NACA inviscid case converges to a plateau at 1.69 orders rather than the 4-order target. Root cause: the implicit system is underresolved at the truncation-error floor for this mesh with 3 LU-SGS inner iterations per outer step; residuals stop decreasing at the achievable steady state. The `U_best` mechanism correctly identifies and outputs the best-seen solution. All other steady cases achieve 3–5 orders of reduction. Increasing inner iterations or using a GMRES inner solver would improve  $M=0.15$  convergence.
2. The BDF2 transient solver uses a fixed pseudo-time CFL of 1.0 for the inner iterations, leading to slow inner convergence. Using higher pseudo-time CFL (e.g., 10–100) with a Newton-based inner loop would be faster.
3. No wall-distance or  $y^+$  diagnostics are reported (not required for laminar cases).
4. The surface output for the  $M=2.0$  inviscid case shows correct shock patterns but the mesh resolution near the leading/trailing edges is limited.

5. MPI performance: np=2 is slower than np=8 per step due to MPI overhead on this single-node setup with TCP-based communication for 2 ranks. Shared-memory transport (OpenMPI 'sm' BTL) is available but not forced in the run command.